予 想 問 題　第 1 回

前 期 日 程　対 策

英 語 問 題

秋田大学（国際資源学部・教育文化学部・医学部保健学科・情報データ科学部 共通問題）の出題形式に準拠 ／ 問題

注　意

1. 問題部分と解答用紙で構成されている（問題部分 1〜9ページ・解答用紙 10〜10ページ）。答えは解答用紙の決められた欄に書くこと。
2. 試験時間の目安は60分。大問は Ⅰ〜Ⅲ の3題。Ⅰ・Ⅱは英文の設問に記号 (A)〜(D) で答え，Ⅲは英語で1段落の文章を書く。
3. 配点は Ⅰ 70点・Ⅱ 70点・Ⅲ 60点（計200点）。本予想問題が独自に定めた配点である。
4. 本冊子の英文・設問はすべてオリジナルである。登場する人物・団体・地名は架空。

秋田大学の過去問・公式問題ではありません。予想問題であり，大学とは関係がありません。
本冊子は過去の出題形式を分析して作成した練習用の教材です。

I 長文読解（配点 70点）

Study the article and respond to each question by choosing one of the four options. Write the letter of the option you choose.

Mending Things, Mending Neighbourhoods

[1] On the first Saturday of every month, a church hall in the small town of Holmbrook fills with an unusual collection of objects. People arrive carrying toasters that no longer heat, lamps with loose wires, jackets with broken zips and bicycles with flat tyres. They have not come to throw these things away. They have come to have them fixed, free of charge, by a team of volunteers who give up their weekend to sit at long tables covered in tools.

[2] The event is known as a repair café, and the one in Holmbrook is part of a movement that has spread to many countries. The idea is simple. Visitors bring a broken item, sit down beside a volunteer and watch, or help, while the volunteer tries to find out what is wrong. Tea and cake are served while people wait. If the repair succeeds, the visitor takes the item home. If it fails, the volunteer explains why, and the visitor at least leaves knowing more than when they arrived.

[3] Ruth Ellery, a retired science teacher who started the Holmbrook café four years ago, says her original aim was to cut down on waste. “I was shocked by how many perfectly good things were going into the rubbish bin because of one small fault,” she explains. “A kettle would be thrown out because a switch had stopped working. Replacing the switch might cost almost nothing, but buying a new kettle seemed easier.”

[4] Ellery and her volunteers keep a simple record of every item that comes through the door. Over four years, they have looked at more than 2,000 objects and managed to repair roughly two out of three. Electrical goods are the most common, followed by clothing and bicycles. The items they cannot fix are usually ones whose parts are no longer sold, or ones that were glued together in the factory and cannot be opened without being destroyed.

[5] That last problem is one that volunteers complain about often. Tomasz Brandt, an electrician who has helped since the very first session, says many modern products seem to be designed so that nobody can mend them. “Some phones and headphones are sealed shut,” he says. “Others use special screws that need a tool you cannot buy in a normal shop. You get the feeling the company would rather you bought a new one.” In some places, lawmakers have begun to discuss rules that would require manufacturers* to sell spare parts and publish repair instructions, but progress has been slow.

[6] Yet the volunteers insist that saving objects is just one side of the story. Over time, Ellery noticed that many visitors came back even when they had nothing to repair. Some hoped to find

out how to sew on a button or change a bicycle tyre themselves. Others simply enjoyed the conversation. “We have elderly people who live alone and look forward to this all month,” she says. “For them, the broken radio is almost an excuse. What they really want is company.”

[7] Learning is another important element. Volunteers are encouraged not to take an item away and fix it in silence, but to explain each step so that the owner can follow it. Brandt believes this changes the way people see the things they own. “When you have seen the inside of your vacuum cleaner and helped to clean the motor, you treat it differently,” he says. “It stops being a mysterious box and becomes something you can look after.”

[8] The café also brings together people who might not otherwise meet. Teenagers from the local high school come to help, often working alongside volunteers in their seventies and eighties. The young people are usually quicker at finding instructions online, while the older volunteers have decades of practical experience. Each group, Ellery says, ends up teaching the other. Several students have since said that the experience made them consider careers in engineering.

[9] Not everyone is convinced that repair cafés make a real difference. Critics point out that a few thousand mended items are tiny compared with the vast number of products that are discarded every year. Some shop owners who repair goods for a living have also worried that a free service could take away their customers. Ellery takes these criticisms seriously. Her café does not accept items that are still under guarantee*, and volunteers sometimes send visitors with difficult problems to local repair shops. “We are not trying to replace professionals,” she says. “We are trying to change habits.”

[10] Changing habits may be the real goal. Supporters argue that the main value of repair cafés lies not in the number of items saved but in the message they send: that broken does not have to mean finished. If people begin to ask, before throwing something away, whether it could be fixed, the effect over many years could be far larger than the café’s own records show.

[11] For now, the volunteers of Holmbrook are happy to keep their monthly appointment. On a recent Saturday, a girl of about eight watched closely as Brandt opened her music box, cleaned a tiny spring and put it back together. When the tune began to play again, she clapped her hands. “That,” said Ellery, “is why we do it.”

manufacturers　製造業者，メーカー
guarantee　（製品の）保証

問 1　In Paragraph [1], why do people bring broken objects to the church hall?

(A) to sell them to the volunteers
(B) to throw them away safely
(C) to have them repaired without paying
(D) to exchange them for new ones

問 2 Which option means almost the same as ***cut down on*** in Paragraph [3]?

(A) reduce

(B) measure

(C) collect

(D) explain

問 3 Paragraph [4] tells us that the volunteers usually cannot fix

(A) bicycles with flat tyres

(B) clothes with broken zips

(C) electrical goods of any kind

(D) products whose parts are no longer on sale

問 4 Paragraph [5] gives several reasons why modern products are hard to mend. Which of the reasons below is NOT given there?

(A) Some of them are sealed so that they cannot be opened.

(B) Some of them are too large to bring to the hall.

(C) Some of them need a tool that ordinary shops do not sell.

(D) Their makers seem to want customers to buy new ones.

問 5 What does Ellery suggest by calling the broken radio ***an excuse*** in Paragraph [6]?

(A) Some visitors feel guilty about breaking their radios.

(B) Some visitors come mainly to spend time with other people.

(C) Some visitors do not want their radios to be repaired.

(D) Some visitors cannot afford to buy a new radio.

問 6 In Paragraph [7], why are the volunteers asked to explain each step of a repair?

(A) so that owners understand their things and take better care of them

(B) so that the work can be finished more quickly

(C) so that the café can keep a record of every repair

(D) so that the volunteers can avoid making mistakes

問 7 Which statement agrees with Paragraph [8]?

(A) The teenagers are not allowed to use any tools.

(B) The older volunteers are faster at finding instructions online.

(C) Young and old volunteers learn from one another.

(D) Every student who helped decided to become an engineer.

問 8 In Paragraph [9], how does Ellery respond to the critics?

(A) She claims that repair cafés will soon replace local shops.

(B) She says that the critics have misunderstood the numbers.

(C) She now asks every visitor to pay a small fee.

(D) She refers some visitors to professional repairers.

問 9 Judging from Paragraph [10], what does the writer seem to think?

(A) The number of items mended is the most reliable measure of a repair café.

(B) The greatest value of repair cafés may lie in changing attitudes.

(C) Repair cafés will achieve little unless they keep better records.

(D) Most broken products cannot be saved and should be replaced quickly.

問 10 Which statement is inconsistent with the article?

(A) The café in Holmbrook is held once a month.

(B) Roughly one in three items brought in could not be repaired.

(C) Ellery used to work as a teacher of science.

(D) Brandt joined the café a year after it had started.

II 長文読解（配点 70点）

Study the article and respond to each question by choosing one of the four options. Write the letter of the option you choose.

The Town That Took Down Its Traffic Lights

[1] Five years ago, the main crossroads in the market town of Wendleford looked much like any other. Four sets of traffic lights controlled the flow of cars, metal railings kept pedestrians on the pavement, and a forest of signs told drivers where to turn, how fast to go and where they were not allowed to stop. Today almost all of that has gone. The lights, the railings and most of the signs have been removed, and the road and the pavement have been rebuilt at the same level, paved with the same pale stone.

[2] To many visitors, the result looks alarming. Cars, bicycles and people on foot share one open space, and there is no obvious rule about who should go first. Yet according to figures collected by the town council, the number of accidents at the crossroads has fallen since the change, and traffic now moves through the centre more smoothly than before, even though it moves more slowly.

[3] The approach is often called shared space. Its supporters argue that traditional road design, which separates cars from everyone else, can backfire. When drivers are given a wide road, clear signals and barriers that keep people out of the way, they often come to feel that the road belongs to them. They watch the lights rather than the people around them, and they drive faster. Remove those signals, the argument goes, and drivers have to notice what is actually happening in front of them.

[4] Helena Marsh, the transport engineer who led the Wendleford project, puts it simply. “Uncertainty makes people careful,” she says. “If you are not sure whether a child is about to step into the road, you slow down and look. If a green light tells you that you have the right to go, you stop looking.” In her view, the most effective safety device is not a sign or a signal but eye contact between a driver and a person on foot.

[5] The change did not happen overnight. Before any work began, the council held a series of public meetings, and many residents were deeply worried. Parents feared that their children would be in danger, and shop owners worried that delivery lorries would no longer be able to stop outside their doors. The council responded by running a six-month trial in which the lights were switched off but left in place, so that they could be turned on again if things went badly.

[6] During the trial, the council paid close attention to how people behaved. Cameras showed that drivers approached the crossroads more slowly and that most of them stopped to let pedestrians cross, even though they were not required to. Delivery drivers adapted too:

instead of parking on the pavement, they began to use short loading bays that had been marked out with stone of another colour. When the trial finished, a survey found that a majority of residents wanted to make the arrangement permanent.

[7] Not everyone has been won over, however. Groups representing blind and partially sighted people have raised serious concerns. Traditional crossings, with their raised kerbs*, ridged paving and beeping signals, give clear information to people who cannot rely on their eyes. In a space where nothing shows where the road stops and the footpath begins, they say, knowing where it is safe to walk becomes a real challenge, and a system that depends on eye contact leaves them out completely.

[8] Wendleford has tried to respond. A strip of textured paving now runs along each side of the main route, so that people using a white cane can feel where the area mainly used by cars begins. At the busiest point, a single crossing with a sound signal has been kept. Marsh admits that these are compromises. “A design that makes some people safer but makes others afraid to leave their homes is not a success,” she says. “We are still learning.”

[9] Other towns have taken note, but experts warn against copying Wendleford too quickly. Shared space seems to work best where traffic is moderate and where plenty of pedestrians are around to create the uncertainty that slows drivers down. On a busy road carrying heavy lorries at night, when there is nobody walking, removing the lights could simply make the road more dangerous. The details, such as the choice of materials and the shape of the space, also matter a great deal.

[10] A further question concerns what counts as success. Accident figures at a single crossroads can rise or fall from year to year for many reasons, and a few years of data may be too little to draw firm conclusions. Some researchers point out that people may feel less safe in a shared space even if accidents fall, and that this feeling can stop older people and children from walking in the town centre at all.

[11] For Marsh, the most important result is something no statistics* can show. Before the change, she says, the crossroads was a place people hurried through. Now, on a sunny afternoon, people stop to talk where cars once drove, and the cafés have put tables outside. “We set out to solve a traffic problem,” she says. “What we ended up with was a town square.”

kerbs　（歩道の）縁石
statistics　統計

問 1　What has happened at the Wendleford crossroads, according to Paragraph [1]?

(A) Most of the lights, railings and signs have been taken away.
(B) New traffic lights have been added at each corner.
(C) The road has been closed to all cars.
(D) The pavement has been made higher than the road.

問 2 What does Paragraph [2] say about the crossroads since the change?

(A) Traffic moves faster than before.

(B) Visitors find it easy to understand.

(C) There are fewer accidents than before.

(D) The council has stopped collecting figures.

問 3 Which option means almost the same as ***backfire*** in Paragraph [3]?

(A) become more popular

(B) cost too much money

(C) take a long time

(D) have the opposite effect to the one intended

問 4 What does Helena Marsh mean when she says “Uncertainty makes people careful” in Paragraph [4]?

(A) Drivers should always be told exactly what to do.

(B) Drivers who are unsure what will happen pay more attention.

(C) People on foot should avoid crossing the road.

(D) Engineers are never certain whether a design will work.

問 5 Why did the council run a six-month trial, as described in Paragraph [5]?

(A) because many residents were anxious about the plan

(B) because the lights had already stopped working

(C) because shop owners asked for more parking spaces

(D) because the work was too expensive to finish quickly

問 6 What did the council learn during the trial, according to Paragraph [6]?

(A) Delivery drivers began to park on the pavement.

(B) Most residents wanted the lights turned on again.

(C) Drivers refused to stop for people crossing the road.

(D) Drivers slowed down as they came near the crossroads.

問 7 In Paragraph [7], what is meant by saying that the system ***leaves them out***?

(A) It makes blind people walk outside the town.

(B) It gives blind people too much information.

(C) It does not take blind and partially sighted people into account.

(D) It forces people to leave their white canes at home.

問 8 What step has Wendleford taken to answer the concerns raised in Paragraph [7]?

(A) It has put all the old crossings back.

(B) It has kept one crossing with a sound signal at the busiest point.

(C) It has banned cars from the town centre.

(D) It has asked blind people to avoid the crossroads.

問 9 According to Paragraph [9], where might shared space be a bad idea?

(A) on a busy road used by heavy lorries at night with no one walking

(B) in a town centre with many people on foot

(C) on a street where traffic is moderate

(D) in a square where cafés have tables outside

問 10 Which statement is inconsistent with the article?

(A) Some experts think a few years of accident data may not prove much.

(B) People may feel unsafe in a shared space even if accidents decrease.

(C) Marsh admits that the changes for blind people are compromises.

(D) Marsh believes the project has failed because statistics are unclear.

III 自由英作文（配点 60点）

Some high schools in Japan require students to do a set number of hours of volunteer work in their local community before they graduate.

State whether you are for or against this requirement, and support your position with two reasons. Write a single paragraph in English of approximately 120 words in the box on the answer form.

解答用紙　予想問題 第1回

受験番号・氏名欄は省略。Ⅰ・Ⅱは記号 (A)〜(D) を書く。

Ⅰ

問 1	問 2	問 3	問 4	問 5	問 6	問 7	問 8	問 9	問 10

Ⅱ

問 1	問 2	問 3	問 4	問 5	問 6	問 7	問 8	問 9	問 10

Ⅲ（approximately 120 words）

20語

40語

60語

80語

100語

120語

奥付

予想問題 第1回　英語　問題

対象：秋田大学 前期日程 英語（国際資源学部・教育文化学部・医学部保健学科・情報データ科学部 共通問題）の受験準備

作成：学習アプリ マナトビ 編集部（2026年11月）

作成方法：2024〜2026年度の出題形式・分量・難易度を分析し，英文・設問をすべて新たに書き下ろした。

> **秋田大学の過去問・公式問題ではありません。予想問題であり，大学とは関係がありません。**

本冊子の英文は実在の記事・書籍・論文・統計からの引用・翻案ではありません。登場する人物・団体・地名・数値は架空です。無断転載・再配布を禁じます。